

Fitore Jaha-Price

www.fitorejaha.com

Toronto, ON

Education

B.Sc. in Computer Sciences,
Hadassah Academic College,
Jerusalem, Israel

Languages

English, Albanian, Hebrew,
Croatian, Intermediate French

Engineering leader with ~20 years building products, platforms, and teams, now focused on what it takes to make AI trustworthy inside regulated engineering organisations. I build the structures for that: governance, semantic layers, and the developer tooling that lets teams move fast and stay auditable. Recently that meant a shared ontology across two merged banks' financial data, and an AI developer platform my guilds built, the bank then adopted to scale. My method: find the constraint that hurts most, build the smallest version that proves the idea, hand it off once it works. I think in systems, with deep care about the humans who are part of them.

EXPERIENCE

EQ/EQUITABLE BANK

Aug 2024 – Present

Hybrid, Toronto, ON

EQ Bank, the Fintech division of Equitable Bank—Canada was established 50+ years ago and holds \$74B+ in assets. Focused on delivering secure, CDIC-insured banking with no hidden fees.

Director of Engineering

Convergence: Acquisition, Onboarding & Cross-sell

Merger with PCF mandate, as of July '26: I own engineering outcomes for acquisition, onboarding, and cross-sell across EQ Bank and PCF. I run both brands' legacy platforms while we build the converged systems that will replace them.

- Designed the org model for convergence: split BAU from build, and built the culture and team strength to run both at once.
- Setting domain boundaries between journey orchestration, identity, product state, and decisioning, backed by explicit events and contracts.
- AI now assists planning, coding, and testing, using Cursor and MCP. Releases stay in human hands, for now.

Personal/Retail Banking & Communities

Aug '24 - Sept '26 pre-merger: Reporting to the CTO, I owned technical strategy, architecture, budget, and vendor decisions for EQ Bank's main revenue domain with ~40 people across four product teams and two platform guilds.

- Built the blueprint and operating model that tied customer journeys to engineering ownership. Five leaders ran their domains under shared standards, scorecards, and cross-team planning.
- Owned the full customer journey from acquisition through daily banking and savings, including the Notice Savings Account launch - cited in EQB earnings as a driver of deposit growth.
- Collaborated with Data to design the shared ontology and semantic layer for financial data across two merged entities as a foundation for AI workloads and analytics.
- Led architecture for post-merger integration: a canonical domain model and

edge gateways across channels, built as a compliance-grounded data layer. Co-published the architecture decisions with staff engineers, so the calls didn't all run through me.

- Built governed AI developer tooling: an MCP gateway and a compliant AI agent workflow, with the AI Centre of Excellence, so developers could use AI to ship faster without losing auditability.
- Coached and promoted engineering managers, opened IC-to-manager pathways, and ran Tech Talks and guilds that raised the technical bar across the org.

WAVE HQ

Aug 2022 – Aug 2024

Remote, Toronto, ON

Wave is one-stop money management for small business owners offering Invoicing, Payments, Accounting, Payroll and Banking tools as a single financial management solution.

Senior Engineering Manager: Accounting, Wave Money and Entitlements

Reported to the VP of Engineering, leading 3 fully remote product domains with up to ~20 direct reports including managers. Scope spanned ML-driven automation, mobile product strategy, and the monetisation infrastructure that governed feature access across Wave's entire product surface.

- Accounting: led the Accounting product engineering team providing ML-driven transaction categorisation (improving reporting accuracy) and deduplication (reducing reconciliation errors). Launched Receipts OCR integration where computer vision improved the UX for automated expense capture.
- Wave Mobile app and Wave Money: championed Wave Money, a small-business credit card with embedded accounting, as the flagship feature of the Wave Mobile app launch. Led end-to-end sunset when the strategic decision was made: migration sequencing, stakeholder communication, and resource reallocation with zero user disruption.
- Entitlements, cross-sell and monetisation layer: launched Wave's SaaS tier transition. The API and data model changes enabled tiered feature access and subscription billing across web and mobile. Entitlements was the integration point between products, governing what each user could access and enabling the cross-sell surface between them.
- Engineering operating model: built the cross-engineering operating infrastructure for the incident response practice, developer tooling and technology working groups. Coached and promoted multiple engineers into Staff IC and EM roles.

WEALTHSIMPLE

Aug 2021 – Jul 2022

Remote, Toronto, ON

Wealthsimple provides powerful, forward-thinking financial tools trusted by millions of Canadians to help them grow and manage

Engineering Manager, Enablement Platform

Led a fully remote team delivering internal tooling for Financial Operations, Client Success, and Engineering. Focused on security, privacy, and data integrity for sensitive client data.

- Governance by design: built Fraud Case Management tooling with row-level data masking, need-to-know access controls, and end-to-end audit trails embedded from the start (policy-as-code). Every fraud and security

their money.

**GOVERNMENT OF CANADA:
CANADIAN DIGITAL
SERVICE / SERVICE
NUMÉRIQUE CANADIEN**

Sept 2020 – Sept 2021

Remote, Toronto, ON

The Canadian Digital Service teams up with federal departments and agencies to put people's needs at the centre of government services.

**CBC/RADIO-CANADA,
CORUS ENTERTAINMENT
(SHAW MEDIA),
WORKOPOLIS,
CRITICAL MASS,
CBC MUSIC,
VODAFONE New Zealand,
CENTRAL 1,
LAT49,
WORIO/FLIPBOARD,
ANSWERS.COM,
THE HEBREW UNIVERSITY OF
JERUSALEM**

operation was auditable by architecture. The philosophy then propagated across the broader internal platform.

- Internal platform architecture: designed and championed a private API gateway as the governed access layer for Wealthsimple's internal tooling, enabling low-code UI development while centralising backend services behind a single auditable surface. Initially deployed for Fraud and Security; extended across Trade, Cash, Invest, and Crypto. (React, Ruby microservices, GraphQL, Kafka.)

Principal Developer & Engineering Manager

Hired as Principal Developer and promoted to Engineering Manager, leading the GC Forms platform. This enabled all government agencies to start moving static forms online securely, accessibly, and at scale.

- Platform architecture: defined the full technical architecture for GC Forms via AWS-managed backend services, React/Next.js frontend, WCAG-compliant shared component system. Built the form viewer, form builder, and data management layers as distinct, maintainable surfaces.
- Design system leadership: championed a government-wide design system that grew beyond GC Forms into a standalone capability with its own dedicated team; built to outlast the project that started it.

Earlier Career · Technical Lead & Staff IC · 2003–2016 Highlights

- National media platform at scale: led architecture and delivery of CBC.ca and harmonisation of gem.cbc.ca and ici.tou.tv into a single bilingual OTT platform, scaling national coverage for 18M+ users.
- Early ML and discovery: contributed to ML-driven discovery and recommendation features at early-stage startups (Worio/Flipboard, Answers.com), blending UI engineering with information retrieval systems.
- Regulated fintech: delivered bilingual, WCAG-compliant banking and fintech solutions for Central 1 (MemberDirect) and CitiBank across web and mobile.